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114 Through The Ages

Digital Business

How Technology Can Help Your Organisation

Tech Careers

Driving The Numbers

A career in the broad area of databases can be technically challenging, intellectually taxing, and financially rewarding

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Any business is dependant on data to a large extent, and data is one of the most valuable assets of any organisation. IT and ITES are used extensively across various industry verticals, and in this info-centric age, data very obviously drives business.

Although databases are managed and maintained in most industry verticals, this is mostly so in Banking, Financial Services and Insurance (BFSI), Telecom, Manufacturing, and E-governance. The first three sectors are growing very fast. Databases in these sectors have become complex, and serve small, medium, and large businesses.

Businesses going online, and real-time transactions, have now increased the requirements for a robust and reliable database infrastructure. A number of different applications and packages such as ERP (Enterprise Resources Planning) and CRM (Customer Resources Management) result in complex databases.

Data has to be managed and maintained well since it plays a crucial role in decision-making. There is a need for a skilled workforce that can manage, maintain, process, and secure databases for the smooth flow of business activities.

Opportunities

Under databases, which is a very broad area, opportunities lie in areas such as software development, administration, management, and the designing of databases. One can jumpstart a career by working in any of these and more to explore broader horizons. The major sectors are banking and financial, manufacturing, telecommunication, education, and retail.

"Database professionals are hot commodities in the IT industry. The service sector needs skills. Many MNCs are outsourcing their IT infrastructure to India. Also, back-end database professionals are an integral and critical part of the IT infrastructure," says Vadiraja Bhatt, Senior Software Architect, ASE-SPEED group, Sybase India.

Scope Of Options

The major areas within databases and allied areas are explained below.

Database Software Development: The profile of the individual here remains the same as in other areas of software development. Good programming, debugging, problem-solving and analytical skills are expected.

Database Administration: The activities here include planning, testing, installing, diagnosing, and maintaining of information in the form of databases in an organisation or any other institutional body. Primary tasks here involve managing databases, developing reports, optimising the computer sys-

Illustration Pradip Ingale

